



Asia

Uzbekistan



Farming cotton
Cotton production is big business, with more than 1 million people working to harvest it.



Local flatbreads

A disc-shaped flatbread called obi non is traditionally baked inside a tandyr, or clay oven.

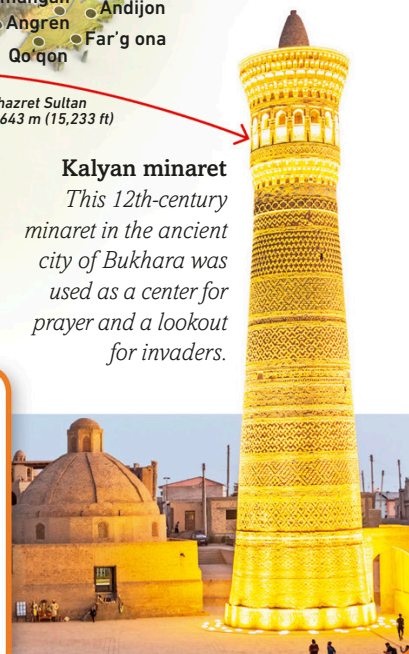
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(approximate scale)



Samarkand was once an important stop on the Silk Road.

Kalyan minaret

This 12th-century minaret in the ancient city of Bukhara was used as a center for prayer and a lookout for invaders.



- 📏 172,742 sq miles (447,400 sq km)
- 👤 30.6 million
- ★ Tashkent
- 🗨️ Uzbek, Russian, Tajik, Kazakh

Desert covers most of Uzbekistan. Even the once-large **Aral Sea** has nearly dried up. Its bustling, ancient **trade-route cities**, such as Samarkand and Bukhara, are home to many **mosques** and **mosaics**.



Turkmenistan



Darvaza crater
Burning since 1971, this gas crater is a natural gas field that collapsed to form a crater 66 ft (20 m) deep.

Traditional dwellings

In the past, most people in Turkmenistan followed a nomadic lifestyle and lived in traditional tents called yurts.



The **Karakum Desert** covers more than two-thirds of the country's total area.

Aýrybaba
3,138 m (10,295 ft)



0 100 km
0 100 miles
(approximate scale)

Turkmen jewelry
Handcrafted by native artisans, ornate jewelry with precious stones—like the headdress and necklace shown here—was a traditional symbol of wealth.



- 📏 188,456 sq miles (488,100 sq km)
- 👤 5.5 million
- ★ Ashgabat
- 🗨️ Turkmen, other languages (+4)

Turkmenistan **borders** the **Caspian Sea** but is mostly sun-baked desert terrain. The country has plentiful **petroleum** and **gas** reserves, and its **main export** is **natural gas**. The two oasis cities of **Mary** and **Tejen** are big **cotton-growing centers**.